How to Create a Stop At Instruction

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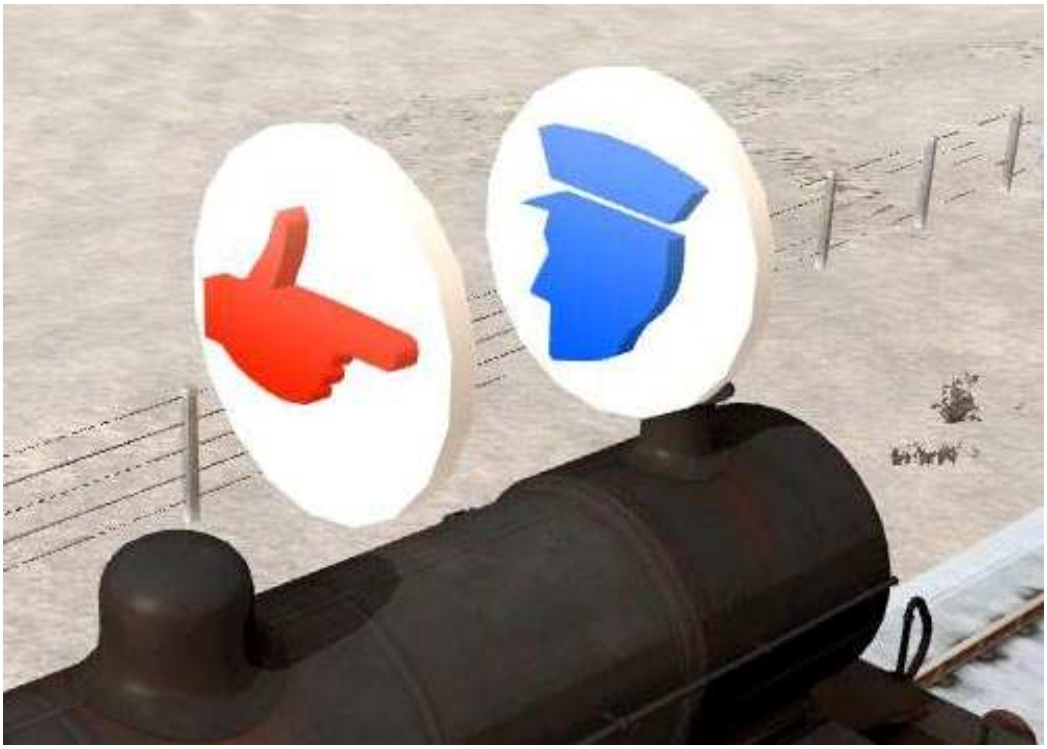
1 Placing a Stop At Instruction

Now that the scenario has been created and the player train created you can begin to add more complex instructions to the scenario.

The first instruction type is Stop At Destination and is located on the upper tab. This is used for when the player needs to stop at a specific location or pass over a specific location at speed.

To add an instruction you press the Stop At Destination button so that it is highlighted, then click on the player locomotive.



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You can see that the instruction disc sits behind the driver icon at the front of the locomotive. Further instructions will stack in the order in which they are placed. Instructions are carried out in order from front to back. If you want to change the order of the instructions, left click and drag it along to the new position. You cannot change the position of the driver disc as that is always first.

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2 Stop At Destination Properties Tab

To edit the Stop At Destination instruction properties, double left click the disc on the locomotive. This will reveal a properties tab on the right hand side of the screen. You will probably want to pin this tab so that it is permanently visible by clicking the pin icon.

Currently all the fields are empty.

Below is a list of each field and a description of what they mean:

Add Instruction: This is the main body of the instruction. To set a destination to stop at you first click the green plus sign then select a valid destination in the world editor. A valid destination can be a platform marker, a siding marker or a destination marker.

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Once a destination has been added it appears in the list. Further Stop At Destination instructions can be added and will appear stacked underneath.

The instructions will complete from top to bottom.

Delete Instruction: To delete an instruction from the list, firstly select the instruction you want to remove and then press the delete icon which looks like a dustbin.

Find: Clicking the magnifying glass icon will bring up a list of available destinations. Selecting a destination from this list will create a Stop at instruction for that destination and add it to the list.

Display Message: The text entered into this field is displayed as a pop-up message in-game when all instructions in the list above are completed successfully.

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Achievement Text Successful: Similar to the above message, except this message is displayed if the whole scenario is completed successfully. This field does not need to be filled in unless it is on the last instruction disc of the scenario.

Achievement Text Unsuccessful: This displays a message if the instruction is not completed successfully. In the case of a Stop At Destination instruction, this would be if the player failed to stop at the required destination.

This would not necessarily mean total failure of the entire scenario if later instructions are still completable.

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3 Editing Individual Stop At Instructions

The separate destination instructions in the list show the name of the destination, the anticipated arrival time, the anticipated departure time, the average expected performance % and the speed needed to complete the instruction.

Several aspects of the separate Stop At Destination instructions can be further edited. Descriptions of what you can change and the effect is described below:

Time Tabled: By default, instructions do not have to adhere to a strict timetable. Unchecking the Time Tabled icon means that the calculated timetable is in force and an operational error is displayed at the end of the scenario if the timetable has been breeched.

Handle Off Path: The dispatcher automatically calculates the best path for the train based on all the values contained in the scenario. Deviating from this path results in an error, which could end up failing the scenario.

There will be times, however, when it should be correct for the player to leave this pre-calculated path. An example would be in yard activities, where the player should be free to use any path through the yard as long as the instruction gets completed.

Leaving the box unchecked means the path does not have to be adhered to, and no error will be given for leaving the path until this instruction is completed.

Checking the box means the path is enforced and the player must stick to it for this instruction.

% Performance: The average expected performance is set to 75% by default. Adjusting this value higher will create a stricter timetable and changing the value lower will create a more relaxed timetable. If this value is edited the anticipated arrival and departure times on this and all subsequent instructions will be updated.

Editing this value is a good way to control the speeds of AI traffic on the route.

MPH: This is the speed at which the player needs to be travelling to complete the instruction. The default speed is 0MPH which is stationary. However, this value can be changed to that a destination needs to be passed at a certain speed. Using a "Stop At Destination" instruction with a speed of 1MPH is a good way to ensure the train takes a certain path. The train will be travelling at a speed of over 1MPH and thus will automatically complete the instruction and move to the next; which

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essentially turns this instruction into a waypoint follower and is especially useful for controlling the exact paths of AI trains.

Instructions set to a speed of over 0MPH will not show up in the Assignment Assistant as they can be used frequently and would clutter up the list. However, they do appear in the Drivers Guide as a Next Destination.

If a destination has been added to the list that the train cannot access (this may be due to directionality of the track, or a break in the track etc) then the expected arrival and departure times are not displayed and are replaced with exclamation marks.

When this error happens, select another destination or check the tracks between your train and the destination looking for errors.

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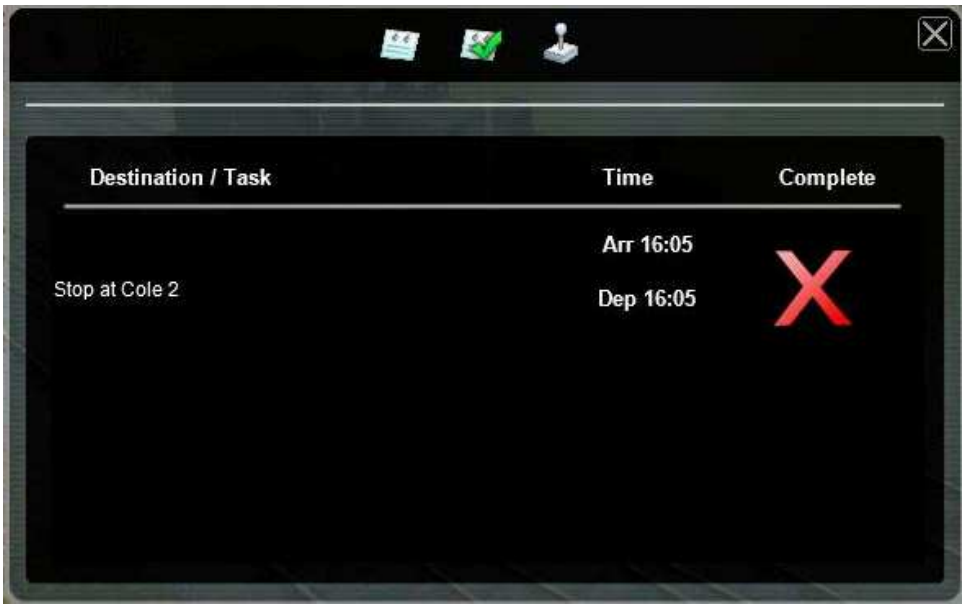
4 Viewing the Instructions

In Drive mode you can check the Assignment Assistant and see the instructions as the end user would when playing the scenario.

This is how a single Stop At Destination instruction appears in the Description tab.

This is how the same instruction appears in the Assignments tab. Notice the large red cross indicates that the instruction has not been completed yet.



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